> The people of Kandahar have always taken pride in their valour and self-respect, and regarded this incident as too serious to be dismissed with just an apology. Though the girl's family and supporters were bullied into silence by the display of British power, the Durrani clan was seething with anger because their pride and honour had been compromised, and their blood was boiling in their veins. Shame and embarrassment was visible on their faces. Even loyal allies among the Durrani khans, such as Haji Khan Kakar, showed that the insult to the tribe rankled with them, and although they contained their anger, their disaffection showed in their behaviour.[57]

The *Siraj ul-Tawarikh* put it more succinctly: 'The seeds of revenge had been planted in the fertile breasts of honour-conscious Afghans, and they eventually bore terrible fruit. The tribal leaders started thinking that the Padishah only wanted wine from the cup of authority, with no regard for his own good name. The Durrani khans were alienated from the Shah by this incident and secretly nursed their grievances until an opportune moment should arrive.'[58]

One who did exactly this was a leading landowner named Aminullah Khan Logari. Aminullah was an elderly Yusufzai Pathan of relatively humble origins – his father had been assistant to the Governor of Kashmir at the time of Timur Shah – and he had risen in the service of the Sadozais. Like many then present in Kandahar he had no objection to the return of the King, but he was horrified that he had done so on the back of an army of foreign infidels. After the incident of the rape, he made his way to Kabul, where he based himself in the Nawab Bagh and 'sought opportunities to foster a coalition with like-minded Mujehedin to oust the British from the country'.[59]

The first acts of resistance to the British soon began to take place. Two officers of the 16th Lancers who had gone off fishing along the banks of the Arghandab were set upon by a crowd of Durranis as they made their way home; one was stabbed and later died. Attacks on British pickets along the road to the Khojak Pass increased, as did attacks on mail runners and messengers. Two hundred camp followers who attempted to make their way back to India 'were betrayed, disarmed and butchered to a man. Every convoy of treasure, ammunition and stores was compelled to fight its way through the passes, and suffered much loss, both in life and baggage.'[60]

The sepoy Sita Ram felt the atmosphere change radically during the two months that the army stayed resting at Kandahar. 'At first people seemed pleased at the Shah's return,' he recalled.